

CLAUDE SKILLS CHEAT SHEET

What is a Skill?

A Skill is a pre-loaded instruction set saved as a markdown file. Upload it once to Claude, and it follows your rules every time — no re-explaining, no re-prompting, no copy-pasting context. Build once, reuse forever.

3 Methods to Build a Skill

1. Skill Creator

Enable Skill-Creator in Settings → Customize → Skills. Tell Claude: "Build me a Skill for [workflow]." It generates the SKILL.md file for you. Review, edit, save.

2. Voice Notes

Record a 2–3 minute voice note explaining any repeatable workflow. Transcribe it using Claude's audio input, Whisper, or your phone's native transcription. Paste the transcript into Claude with the Voice-to-Skill prompt.

3. External Knowledge

Dump PDFs, docs, examples, or any reference material into a Claude Project. The more context you provide, the better the Skill. Claude builds from everything you give it.

Skill Folder Structure

File	Purpose
SKILL.md	Required. Core instructions, rules, and examples.
TEMPLATE.md	Optional. Input format guide for the user.
REFERENCE.md	Optional. Examples, documentation, and reference material.

3 Mistakes to Avoid

✗ Vague descriptions

Your Skill description is the trigger. If it's generic, Claude won't know when to activate the Skill. Be specific about what it does and when to use it.

✗ Mega-Skills

Don't cram 10 workflows into one Skill. One Skill = one job. Split complex workflows into separate, focused Skills.

✗ Skipping the eval

Always test your Skill with real prompts before saving. Use Claude's built-in eval to compare output with and without the Skill loaded.

20 Skill Ideas

Content Creation

Brand Voice Writer • Blog Post Drafter • Social Media Thread Writer • Newsletter Builder • Video Script Outliner

Business Ops

Email Drafter • Meeting Notes → Action Items • SOPs & Process Docs • Client Proposal Generator • Invoice & Receipt Formatter

Personal Productivity

Research Synthesizer • Grammar & Tone Checker • ELI5 Explainer • Job Application Tailor • Learning Path Builder

Advanced

PDF Generator • Data Report Builder • Competitor Analysis Brief • Code Review Checklist • Customer Feedback Analyzer